Zayd Mahmud

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Education

Plano West Senior High School — Plano, Texas
Rank: 70/1,189 (Top 5.8%) · GPA: 4.61 (W) / 4.46 (UW) — *Expected Grad: May 2027*
SAT: 1570 (770RW / 790M) · ACT: 36 · PSAT: 1500 (SI 225)

Experience

Independent Debate Coach and Consultant — Plano, Texas
Director of Debate, GEM Academy and Lead PF Consultant, Outreach Debate — *Apr 2025 – Present*
- Coached **50+** debaters to state qualifications, TOC bids, and the **2026 Texas PF Championship**.
- Authored and open-sourced **$15K+** in resources to **500+** debaters globally, instructing **6 free camps** over **500+** hours.
- Managed GEM's seasonal program logistics, supervised 4 instructional peers, and coordinated thousands in cash flow.

Freelance 3D Artist (@zira3d) — Plano, Texas
3D Generalist — *Jun 2022 – Present*
- Ran a **5-figure** 3D production business from concept to delivery; reinvested profits into studio hardware.
- Garnered **1M+** impressions and acclaim from **Riot Games, Bungie**, and **Halo Studios**.

BASMAH Foundation — Dallas-Fort Worth, Texas
Motivational Speaker and Emcee — *Jun 2025 – Sep 2026*
- Keynoted galas raising **$500K+** to deliver water, shelter, and schooling to **80,000+** Rohingya refugees.
- Coordinated program logistics, stage management, and live audience engagements for events with hundreds of donors.

Al-Ihsan Social Development Center — Dallas-Fort Worth, Texas
Motivational Speaker and Outreach Coordinator — *Dec 2024 – Present*
- Keynoted galas raising **$240K+** to build, sustain grade school and orphanage serving **1,300+ families** in rural Bangladesh.
- Organized nightly events, mosque visits, and guest scholar hospitality during 6-figure Ramadan fundraising run.

City of Richardson – Office of the Mayor — Richardson, Texas
Media Specialist — *Apr 2026 – Present*
- Directed over a dozen shoots, filming and editing short- and long-form content series to elevate mayoral brand image.
- Helped expand channel following to **7.7K followers,** impacting **100K+** constituents.

Jason Pearce for Congress — Plano, Texas
Media Director — *Apr 2026 – Present*
- Co-founded multimedia team for TX CD-4 Democratic candidate; managed campaign outreach and research.
- Exec. director of production, oversaw media campaign reaching **270k+ voters** in the 2026 cycle.

Islamic Association of Collin County — Plano, Texas
Guest Speaker and Emcee — *Sep 2021 – Present*
- Programmed, emceed annual banquets addressing **300+** educators; advocated for interfaith unity at regional events.

Volunteer Teacher — *Sep 2021 – May 2023*
- Curated and taught K–8 curricula in Islamic ethics, history, and Arabic for **100+ students**.
- Taught 30+ in sole special-needs Arabic program. Managed parent reports, student discipline, and mentorship.

Leadership & Activities

Speech and Debate – Plano West HS, Jasper HS, Rice MS — Plano, Texas
Team Captain and Lincoln-Douglas Debater — *Sep 2021 – Present*
- Ranked **#24 nationally**; Harvard semifinalist (3rd/248, TOC Bid); **top 32 globally**, IPPF essay competition.
- Ranked **2nd in Texas,** won **5 Texas titles**, only sophomore competitor in TFA State T16, 2025.
- Mentored teams of **200+** debaters; organized practices, summer fundraiser camp raising **$14K** with **120+** participants.

Boy Scouts of America – Troops 261 and 2060 — Plano, Texas
Eagle Scout, Senior Patrol Leader, Camp Staff and Lifeguard — *May 2020 – Sep 2025*
- Earned **Eagle Scout** rank (top 2%); planned, led **$1.4K** community center restoration supervising 10+ volunteers.
- Mentored 30+ scouts through **70+** advancements; served summer and winter camps as lifeguard, merit badge counselor.

Muslim Student Association – Plano West HS and Jasper HS — Plano, Texas
Co-President — *Aug 2023 – May 2025*
- Coordinated interfaith events and **daily prayers for hundreds** of high school students across DFW.
- Liased with Plano ISD administration to protect student prayer rights and encourage MSA chapters district-wide.

Honors & Awards

NSDA Academic All-American: Coach-nominated award for leadership and scholastic excellence; **top 1%** of competitors.
IACC Youth Excellence Award: Inaugural award recognizing outstanding Plano youth leadership, service, or achievement.
Bungie Artist of the Week: Selected out of 10K+ community art submissions for feature in weekly newsletter.
Halo Studios Community Spotlight: Selected out of 3K+ art submissions for monthly community accolade.